

Watch OS v1.x

The first version of the watchOS powered the first apple smart watch. Like the first version of most new tech, it was crude and rough around the edges, with some nice features but still lacking the overall cohesiveness and flexibility that is required from a wearable gadget like a smartwatch.

One could choose from 9 preset watch faces which included the chronograph, modular, utility and something called Mickey Mouse which is basically an analogue clock face with Mickey in the center using his hands to tell time.

The OS came preloaded with 20 standard applications but had no support for development of third party apps. These apps covered most of the basic needs one has from a smart watch and included Alarm, Calendar, a camera remote, Mail, Maps, Messages, Music, Timer, Stopwatch, Weather update and phone. An update to the OS came out a month later which improved the performance of the device and added some more nifty features like a calorie calculator, and a distance and pace meter, improved Siri along with additional language support.

Watch OS v2.x

Released in September of 2015, only a couple of months after the launch of the first Apple Watch and Watch OS v1, The V2 was a big improvement over the first version with the biggest addition being support for 3rd party applications. Apple released its WatchKit framework for developers leading to a number of 3rd party apps coming out for the Watch. The official Facebook messenger app was released and it let you not only send messages, but also share audio and location straight from your wrist without having to take out your phone. Another neat application was the GoPro viewfinder which let you use your camera right from your watch.

The new update also cleared a number of issues and limitations of the previous models like the adaption of tetherless WiFi technology. Earlier you needed your iPhone to connect your watch to the internet, but not so anymore. Apple added many new watch faces and increased the customisability, letting you set any photo or album as the background of the device.

Another new feature that came with the update was the nightstand mode. Place your watch sideways while charging on your nightstand and it turns into a mini alarm, with the digital crown becoming the snooze button and the side button turning into alarms.